applicable to Hinduism, and it is absurd to look at Hinduism from the third standpoint. Even with regard to the last interpretation, Zaehner should see that, if as he maintains, "in the Christian west, on the other hand, religion has been primarily concerned with what is deemed to be divine revelation and *with the correct interpretation of the content* of that revelation" (p. 56),[5] then the fact that the divine revelation needs a correct interpretation takes away much of its character as a revelation. If, according to the revelationists, it is the interpretation which is going to decide the contents of revelation, then the revelationist has given up his case altogether. According to Zaehner, "Experience, when divorced from revelation, often leads to absurd and wholly irrational excesses" (p. 57). Has it occurred to him that revelation, when divorced from experience, not only often leads, but has many times in history actually led to absurd and even more irrational excesses?

To summarize, the whole argument of the book runs something like this: the Indians, the Hindus and the Buddhists both, have made great contributions in the realm of the highest psychological stages to which man can attain and have made great and praiseworthy suggestions about the nature of the universe and its relation to man, but they do not have or believe in the revelation of Jesus Christ, hence they do not and cannot teach much about God. This kind of argument does not need any comment. If, however, Zaehner is obsessed by the idealistic absolutism of the Upaniṣads and the Vedānta, let him remember that in India these have the same relationship with Hinduism as Christianity has with Hegelianism or dialectical materialism. There is no limit to Zaehner's absurdities about Indian religions. "Indian theology, then, starts as Dialectical Materialism, and proceeds progressively from materialism to Idealism" (p. 64). It is difficult to imagine such a characterization of Indian theology until one reads Zaehner. If theology is to be understood in the usual sense, how possibly can dialectical materialism ever be characterized as theology? Upaniṣadic "Brahman is food," "Brahman is air," and so forth were, according to Zaehner, laid down as principles of dialectical materialism "millenia before Marx and Engels were ever heard of" (p. 63). This is just one more example of Zaehner's continuous misuse of terms and the lack of any serious distinction between generalized thought and theology on the one hand, and religion and philosophy on the other.

His two observations about the *Bhagavad Gītā* would not be amiss here. Zaehner says "this is perhaps the greatest weakness of the theology of the Bhagavad Gītā. God has no purpose in creating